The Course of the Great War (1914–1919)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 40 QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



Primary Historical Records: Archduke Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo (June 1914) & the signing of the Treaty of Versailles in the Hall of Mirrors (June 1919).

LESSON UNIT	ATT 1 SCORE	ATT 2 SCORE	RETRIEVAL STRENGTH	PARENT INITIALS
Enquiry 1: Recruitment & Propaganda *Why were millions of young men desperate to enlist in 1914?*	___ / 8	___ / 8	[ ] Instant [ ] Effortful [ ] Restudy	
Enquiry 2: Trench Warfare & The Somme *Did British generals make the horror of trench warfare worse?*	___ / 8	___ / 8	[ ] Instant [ ] Effortful [ ] Restudy	
Enquiry 3: Empire Troops & Global Reach *How much of a "World" War was it, and why were colonial troops forgotten?*	___ / 8	___ / 8	[ ] Instant [ ] Effortful [ ] Restudy	
Enquiry 4: The Home Front & DORA *How did a war fought miles away completely control daily life in Britain?*	___ / 8	___ / 8	[ ] Instant [ ] Effortful [ ] Restudy	
Enquiry 5: Versailles & The Middle East *Did the Treaty of Versailles solve the problems of 1914, or create the nightmares of 1939?*	___ / 8	___ / 8	[ ] Instant [ ] Effortful [ ] Restudy	

- **7–8/8 Mastered:** Secure factual recall.
- **5–6/8 Consolidate:** Flashcard restudy on missed terms.
- **<5/8 Action Required:** Mandatory re-test after DIRT corrections.

Scan for Interactive Digital Quizzes & Audio Lessons:
Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at **the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app**.

1. ► Approximately how many professional soldiers made up the British Expeditionary Force (BEF) in August 1914?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

2. ► Who was appointed British Secretary of State for War in August 1914 and appeared on famous recruitment posters?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

3. ► What was the nickname given to battalions of friends, workmates, and neighbours who enlisted together?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

4. ►► Why did hundreds of thousands of young British men rush to enlist in August and September 1914?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

5. ►► How did British propaganda posters persuade men to volunteer before conscription was introduced?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

6. ►► What symbol of cowardice was handed to men in civilian clothes on the streets of Britain?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

7. ►►► Why did the concept of "Pals Battalions" ultimately prove to be a catastrophic social disaster?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

8. ►►► How did the transition from a small professional army to a mass citizen army transform British society?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

9. ► What series of maneuvers in late 1914 ended open fighting and created the 400-mile Western Front?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

10. ► What dangerous medical condition was caused by soldiers standing in cold, waterlogged mud for days?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

11. ► Which weapon was responsible for approximately 60% of all combat casualties on the Western Front?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

12. ►► Why were frontline trenches constructed in a zig-zag or traverse pattern rather than straight lines?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

13. ►► Why was attacking across "No Man's Land" suicidal against defensive firepower?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

14. ►► Why did the British artillery bombardment fail to destroy German defences before the Battle of the Somme (1916)?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

15. ►►► Why is Field Marshal Sir Douglas Haig remembered both as a callous "Butcher" and the architect of victory?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

16. ►►► How did the development of tanks and combined-arms tactics eventually break the trench deadlock in 1918?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

17. ► Approximately how many Indian soldiers and non-combatant labourers served the British Empire during the war?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

18. ► Who was the first South Asian soldier to be awarded the Victoria Cross (VC) in October 1914?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

19. ► What historic English royal building in Brighton was converted into a military hospital for wounded Indian troops?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

20. ►► What exhausting and dangerous physical duties were men of the British West Indies Regiment (BWIR) primarily restricted to?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

21. ►► Why was the 1915 Gallipoli Campaign launched against the Ottoman Empire?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

22. ►► How did the Battle of Gallipoli forge a powerful national identity for Australia and New Zealand (ANZAC)?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

23. ►►► Why were the massive wartime contributions of colonial and Commonwealth soldiers largely forgotten in Europe after 1918?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

24. ►►► How did fighting in the Great War accelerate demands for national independence across the British Empire?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

25. ► What emergency law passed on 8 August 1914 gave the British government vast powers to control daily life?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

26. ► What was the nickname given to women working in dangerous explosives factories whose skin turned yellow?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

27. ► In what year did the British government introduce compulsory military conscription for single men?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

28. ►► What term was used for men who refused to serve in the armed forces on moral or religious grounds?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

29. ►► Why did the British government regulate pub opening hours and water down beer under DORA?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

30. ►► Why was compulsory food rationing introduced across Britain in early 1918?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

31. ►►► How did women's vital work in wartime industry and transport challenge traditional Victorian gender roles?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

32. ►►► To what extent was the Representation of the People Act 1918 a reward for women's wartime service?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

33. ► On what exact date and time did the Armistice on the Western Front come into effect, ending the fighting?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

34. ► Which three Allied leaders dominated the 1919 Paris Peace Conference as "The Big Three"?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

35. ► What was the official number of the controversial "War Guilt Clause" in the Treaty of Versailles?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

36. ►► What huge financial sum was Germany ordered to pay in reparations for war damages in 1921?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

37. ►► What severe military restrictions were imposed on Germany's armed forces by the Treaty of Versailles?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

38. ►► What secret 1916 agreement between Britain and France planned to carve up Ottoman Middle East territories?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

39. ►►► What was the 1917 Balfour Declaration, and why did it create enduring conflict in the Middle East?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

40. ►►► Did the Treaty of Versailles fail because it was too harsh, or because the Allies failed to enforce it?

Answer: _____

Detail: _____

Department Marking Bank • Part 1: Enquiries 1–3 (Q1–Q20)

ENQUIRY 1: RECRUITMENT & PROPAGANDA (Q1–Q8)

1. ► **120,000 men** — Britain had a small, highly trained professional army compared to the mass conscript armies of France and Germany.

2. ► **Lord Horatio Kitchener** — Kitchener correctly predicted a long, brutal war lasting at least three years requiring an army of millions.

3. ► **Pals Battalions** — Units like the Grimsby Chums and Accrington Pals allowed men to serve side-by-side, boosting recruitment.

4. ►► **A wave of patriotic enthusiasm, peer pressure, and the popular belief that the war would be over by Christmas** — Young men viewed enlistment as an exciting adventure, an escape from boring factory work, and a moral duty.

5. ►► **By appealing to national pride, portraying German soldiers as barbaric, and using guilt about protecting families** — Iconic posters asked "What did you do in the Great War, Daddy?" to make civilian men feel ashamed of not enlisting.

6. ►► **A white feather** — The White Feather movement used intense public humiliation to shame young men into joining the armed forces.

7. ►►► **Heavy casualties at the Somme wiped out an entire generation of young men from the same towns on a single day** — When local battalions were devastated, whole communities lost virtually all their young fathers, brothers, and sons at once.

8. ►►► **It made the war a shared national trauma that touched every household, town, and social class in the country** — The unprecedented scale of enlistment laid the groundwork for total war and sweeping postwar social changes.

ENQUIRY 2: TRENCH WARFARE & THE SOMME (Q9–Q16)

9. ► **The "Race to the Sea"** — Both sides tried to outflank each other until defensive trench networks stretched unbroken from Switzerland to the North Sea.

10. ► **Trench Foot** — Prolonged exposure to damp mud caused bacterial infection, numbness, and gangrene, often requiring foot amputation.

11. ► **Heavy Artillery (high-explosive shells)** — Massive artillery barrages pulverized trenches, caused horrific shrapnel wounds, and induced severe shell shock.

12. ►► **To stop enemy machine-gunners firing down the entire length and to contain artillery blast shockwaves** — The angular design isolated explosions and ensured that if an enemy entered a trench, they could not shoot far ahead.

13. ►► **Barbed wire entanglements trapped infantry while rapid-firing machine guns and artillery mowed them down** — Industrial defensive weapons held an overwhelming tactical advantage over advancing infantry throughout most of the war.

14. ►► **A third of the shells were duds and the deep German concrete bunkers protected soldiers beneath the bombardment** — When the week-long bombardment ended, German soldiers emerged from deep dugouts to set up machine guns before the British arrived.

15. ►►► **Critics condemn his costly attrition tactics, while defenders argue he adapted modern technology to defeat Germany in 1918** — Haig presided over 57,000 casualties on 1 July 1916, but later mastered combined-arms warfare in the decisive Hundred Days Offensive.

16. ►►► **Tanks crushed barbed wire, protected infantry, and worked with creeping artillery barrages and aircraft to breakthrough lines** — Coordinated warfare replaced futile infantry charges, restoring mobility to the battlefield during the final Allied offensives.

ENQUIRY 3: EMPIRE TROOPS & GLOBAL REACH (Q17–Q20)

17. ► **Approximately 1.3 million men** — The Indian Army provided essential divisions on the Western Front, in Gallipoli, and across the Middle East.

18. ► **Sepoy Khudadad Khan VC** — Serving with the 129th Duke of Connaught's Own Baluchis at Hollebeke, he fought his machine gun alone despite severe wounds.

19. ► **The Royal Pavilion** — The exotic oriental palace was transformed into a showcase hospital with separate kitchens and prayer areas for Hindu, Muslim, and Sikh troops.

20. ►► **Carrying heavy live artillery shells, building roads, and digging frontline trenches under enemy fire** — British military authorities imposed racial restrictions, refusing to let Black soldiers fight in frontline combat on the Western Front.

Department Marking Bank • Part 2: Enquiries 3–5 (Q21–Q40)

ENQUIRY 3: EMPIRE TROOPS & GLOBAL REACH (Q21–Q24)

21. **To knock the Ottomans out of the war, open a sea route to Russia, and break the stalemate on the Western Front** — Conceived by Winston Churchill, the amphibious invasion failed disastrously amid fierce Turkish resistance on steep cliffs.

22. **The bravery, endurance, and heavy sacrifices of the ANZAC soldiers became a founding national legend of independence** — Anzac Day on 25 April remains the principal day of national remembrance in Australia and New Zealand.

23. **European commemorative narratives focused almost exclusively on white soldiers and the Western Front battlefields** — Decades of Eurocentric textbooks ignored the global reach of the war and the crucial sacrifices of Asian, Caribbean, and African troops.

24. **Colonial soldiers saw European weakness firsthand and expected political self-government in exchange for their wartime loyalty** — Broken British promises in India and the Caribbean triggered mass strikes, nationalist revolts, and the rise of Gandhi's independence movement.

ENQUIRY 4: THE HOME FRONT & DORA (Q25–Q32)

25. **The Defence of the Realm Act (DORA)** — DORA allowed the state to censor newspapers, take over factories, arrest suspects without trial, and regulate daily habits.

26. **"Canary Girls"** — Exposure to toxic TNT chemicals during shell filling stained their skin and hair bright yellow and caused severe liver damage.

27. **1916 (Military Service Act)** — Heavy casualties on the Western Front forced Britain to abandon voluntary recruitment and draft men aged 18 to 41.

28. **Conscientious Objectors ("Conchies")** — Many were forced before tribunals, imprisoned with hard labour in Dartmoor, or assigned to non-combatant medical units.

29. **To stop industrial absenteeism and ensure factory workers produced munitions at maximum efficiency** — Lloyd George famously warned that "drink is doing us more damage in the war than all the German submarines put together."

30. **German unrestricted submarine warfare sank Allied merchant ships, causing severe shortages of sugar, butter, and meat** — German U-boats came close to cutting off Britain's overseas food supply, making fair rationing essential to prevent starvation.

31. **By proving women could perform heavy, skilled physical labour just as effectively as men, earning financial independence** — Over one million women entered the workforce as bus conductors, police officers, railway workers, and munitions makers.

32. **It granted the vote to women over 30 with property, partly recognizing war work and avoiding pre-war suffragette militancy** — While a landmark constitutional breakthrough, younger working-class women under 30 who worked in factories still had to wait until 1928.

ENQUIRY 5: VERSAILLES & THE MIDDLE EAST (Q33–Q40)

33. **11 November 1918 at 11:00 am (the eleventh hour of the eleventh day of the eleventh month)** — German representatives signed the surrender terms in a railway carriage in the Compiègne Forest in France.

34. **Georges Clemenceau (France), David Lloyd George (Britain), and Woodrow Wilson (USA)** — The leaders had conflicting goals: Clemenceau wanted revenge, Wilson sought ideal peace, and Lloyd George balanced both.

35. **Article 231** — Article 231 forced Germany to accept sole moral responsibility for causing all the loss and damage of the war.

36. **£6.6 billion ($33 billion)** — The crippling indemnity was intended to pay for repairing devastated French towns and pensions for Allied soldiers.

37. **Army restricted to 100,000 volunteers, conscription banned, no tanks, no air force, and navy limited to six battleships** — The Allies aimed to dismantle Germany's offensive capability so it could never launch another European invasion.

38. **The Sykes-Picot Agreement** — Diplomat Mark Sykes and François Georges-Picot drew arbitrary lines in the sand, dividing Syria, Lebanon, Iraq, and Palestine.

39. **A British pledge supporting a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine while promising not to prejudice existing Arab rights** — Contradictory British promises to both Arab leaders and Zionist movements created decades of bitter territorial and national struggle.

40. **It humiliated and economically enraged Germany while leaving its industrial core strong enough to rearm twenty years later** — Condemned by Germans as an unjust "Diktat", Versailles fostered deep political resentment that Adolf Hitler exploited to destroy the Weimar Republic.